

Back-of-book teasers: story

Fiction dos and don'ts. Distilled editorial guidance; source key on page 2.

Focus	DO	DON'T	Source
Opening hook	Lead with the book's distinctive premise or immediate pressure. Give readers a concrete reason to continue.	Begin with generic danger, vague destiny, or background before anything happens.	R1
Protagonist	Identify the central character and what they want. Supply only the background needed to understand that desire.	List the cast, biographies, or every viewpoint before establishing a central concern.	I1
Disruption	Show the event or obstacle that upsets the character's situation and sets the story moving.	Offer a sequence of unrelated incidents without a clear connection to the character's goal.	I1
Stakes	Specify what the character stands to lose. Match the scale of the threat to the actual book.	Rely on "everything is at stake," or exaggerate a personal conflict into world-ending peril.	R1
Story selection	Choose the premise and a few compelling developments that make the reader want the experience.	Compress the whole narrative arc, subplots, and resolution into a miniature synopsis.	R2
Spoiler boundary	Reveal enough setup to create curiosity; preserve the discovery that makes reading worthwhile.	Explain the solution, final outcome, or major reveal merely to make the plot sound complete.	R2
Setting and lore	Include the context readers need to grasp the conflict. Make unfamiliar terms earn their space.	Require readers to decode a glossary, family tree, or history lesson before understanding the problem.	I1
Tone and genre	Let diction and emphasis suggest the book's actual emotional experience and genre.	Promise a light romance for a grim tragedy, or sell quiet fiction as a relentless action thriller.	R1
Factual fidelity	Keep plot claims, relationships, motives, and capabilities faithful to the book, even when simplifying.	Invent a betrayal, deadline, power, romance, or choice because it makes the pitch sound stronger.	B2
Closing hook	Leave a specific tension unresolved. Choose a question or statement according to what reads best.	Force a rhetorical question or assume a question automatically improves response.	B1

Applying the guidance

A useful drafting sequence	Character and pressure → disruption and complication → stakes and unresolved tension. Adapt the order to the strongest angle.
A quick reader test	After one read, can someone explain who wants what, what blocks them, and why the outcome matters?
Scope	This guide concerns the fiction teaser itself. Endorsements, author biography, barcode, and retail metadata are separate elements.
Evidence note	BookBub findings concern short promotional emails. Their craft lessons inform this guide; their metrics do not establish print-cover results.

Back-of-book teasers: craft

Writing, testing, and the Sol → DeepSeek process. Researched September 20, 2026.

Focus	DO	DON'T	Source
Length	Use 150–200 words as a starting range; adapt to genre and available cover space.	Treat that range as universal, or confuse BookBub’s 25–50-word email blurbs with back-cover copy.	R1/B2
Readability	Use short, readable blocks and enough space around the copy in the actual cover layout.	Pack text edge to edge or shrink type to rescue an overlong draft.	R2
Verbs	Favor active verbs and clear sentences that show what characters do and what threatens them.	Let passive constructions or strings of adjectives carry the entire pitch.	B1
Voice	Choose viewpoint and voice that suit the genre; compare effective blurbs for similar books.	Declare third person mandatory for every genre. First-person romance copy can also work.	I1
Comparable books	Use a comparison only when it helps readers understand the likely experience and genuinely fits.	Borrow a famous title for prestige while promising an experience this book does not deliver.	B2
Praise and claims	Use genuine, relevant endorsements or accolades when helpful; let the story stand alone when none exist.	Invent praise, awards, review totals, or bestseller status to fill a marketing slot.	B2
Alternative drafts	Try different hooks and emphases, gather reader feedback, then revise the strongest version.	Assume the first fluent draft is best or mistake superficial word swaps for a different approach.	I1
Final edit	Check clarity, flow, economy, tone, and whether character, conflict, and stakes remain understandable.	Keep an elegant sentence that adds confusion, repetition, or an unsupported promise.	R1
Sol’s handoff	Select only the verified facts wanted in that version; keep evidence and excluded details in private notes.	Send the whole synopsis or a list of spoiler facts and expect DeepSeek to decide what to omit.	House
Output checks	Require three paragraphs and 150–200 words; verify both, then review fidelity and appeal separately.	Treat a model’s claimed word count as proof, or equate format compliance with factual accuracy.	House

Sources and scope

[R1 Reedsy: How to Write a Book Blurb](#)

[I1 Jane Friedman / IngramSpark: Compelling Back Cover Copy](#)

[R2 Reedsy: How to Build a Book Back Cover](#)

[B1 BookBub: Blurb Anatomy and Copy Tests](#)

[B2 BookBub: How Editors Write Featured Deals Blurbs](#)

House = our agreed Sol → DeepSeek workflow, not a published universal rule.
Guidance is paraphrased and adapted for fiction. Source links are clickable. 2 of 2